

OMKARESHWAR COMPLETE PILGRIMAGE GUIDE

Jyotirlinga #4 • OM-Shaped Island • Sacred Narmada River

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About Omkareshwar

Omkareshwar is one of India's most visually stunning pilgrimage sites — a natural island in the Narmada river that forms the sacred shape of OM (■) when viewed from above. Home to the 4th Jyotirlinga, it draws lakhs of devotees annually. Located in Khandwa district of Madhya Pradesh, ~130 km from Ujjain (the circuit hub) and ~77 km from Indore. The Narmada river here is considered even holier than the Ganga in some Shaiva traditions.

THE TWO SACRED TEMPLES

OMKARESHWAR JYOTIRLINGA

ON THE ISLAND

Main temple on Mandhata island. Climb 84 steps to reach the sanctum. Self-manifested (Swayambhu) lingam. Darshan: 5AM–12:30PM, 4PM–10PM. Morning aarti: 5:30AM.

MAMLESHWAR TEMPLE

SOUTH BANK

Located on south bank directly opposite the island. Southern manifestation of the Jyotirlinga. Both temples must be visited for complete darshan. Open all day.

6 SACRED EXPERIENCES AT OMKARESHWAR

- **Narmada Boat Parikrama:** Circumnavigate the island by boat. The OM shape is visible from the water. Most spiritually significant activity. ■50–100 per person. Available all day.
- **Jyotirlinga Darshan:** Climb 84 steps to the main temple. Morning darshan 5AM–7AM is least crowded. Abhishek can be booked through temple priests at the counter.
- **Narmada Ghat Aarti:** Evening aarti on the river banks at 8:30PM. The temple lights reflected in the Narmada create a magical atmosphere. One of MP's most beautiful aarti experiences.
- **Island Parikrama on Foot:** Walk the 6 km circumambulation path around the island. Takes 2–3 hours. Pass 68 minor temples and sacred spots. Best done early morning.
- **Holy Dip in Narmada:** Bathing at the Omkareshwar ghat at dawn is considered highly auspicious. Narmada Jayanti (Jan–Feb) draws lakhs for sacred bath.
- **Mamleshwar Abhishek:** Book a special abhishek (ritual bathing of lingam) at Mamleshwar temple on the south bank. Pandit will guide through the complete ritual.

HOW TO REACH OMKARESHWAR

✈️ ■ Via Indore Airport	Fly to Indore (77 km from Omkareshwar). Cab from Indore to Omkareshwar: ■1,500–2,000.
■ Via Ujjain	Best railway hub. Ujjain to Omkareshwar: ~130 km, ~2.5 hours by cab. ■2,000–2,800. Or t
■ Via Nalkheda	Nalkheda to Omkareshwar: ~130 km via Agar–Indore highway, ~2.5 hours. Book cab via W
■ From Indore	Indore to Omkareshwar: ~77 km, ~1.5 hours. Most popular route for day trips from Indore c
■ By Bus	State buses available from Indore, Ujjain, and Khandwa to Omkareshwar. Private buses als

WHERE TO STAY AT OMKARESHWAR

Narmada Retreat	River view, AC rooms, pure veg meals, peaceful location. ■1,200–2,500/night. Book via na
Temple Guest Houses	Multiple options near Mamleshwar temple. ■400–900/night. Basic but clean.
Dharamshalas	Free to ■300/night on donation basis. Limited rooms — book in advance especially for Nav
Booking.com	Best deals and reviews: nalkheda.in → Omkareshwar → Hotel booking link.

ESSENTIAL OMKARESHWAR TIPS

- Arrive the evening before for sunrise darshan at 5AM — the island looks magical at dawn.
- Do the boat parikrama BEFORE temple darshan for the best spiritual experience.
- Wear sturdy footwear — the 84 temple steps and island parikrama path can be slippery.
- Narmada water is considered sacred — collect some in a small bottle to take home.
- No photography inside the Jyotirlinga sanctum — respect the sacred space.
- Carry cash — island shops and prasad stalls are cash only.
- ■ Avoid Kartik Purnima (Oct–Nov) — extremely crowded. Maha Shivaratri is a must-attend.
- Cab + hotel + yatra planning: WhatsApp +91 97547 09571 ([nalkheda.in](#))

Omkareshwar Complete Pilgrimage Guide

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Jai Omkareshwar! Jai Narmada Maiya! ■